

Samsung shows off giant plasma screen

December 16, Samsung unveiled what is possibly the world's largest plasma monitor screen—a 102-inch high-density panel codenamed “Atlas.” The resolution is only 1,920 x 1,080, but the contrast ratio is 2000:1—enough to leave most of us drooling.



Petabytes By 2008

The Storage Networking Industry Association (SNIA) of India estimates that the country will have 52.7 petabytes (a petabyte is a thousand terabytes) of storage capacity in the next four years, as against the current 5.5 petabytes.



Enter

Shiamak Davar
Actor

Shiamak Davar, one of India's most prolific dancer-choreographers, has redefined the art of dance. He is known for his unique props, costumes and innovative styles. *Digit* caught up with him on one of his shows.

What does technology mean to you?

Greek! On second thoughts though, it has opened up new vistas for information, communication and knowledge.

What kind of gadgets do you use in everyday life?

I am addicted to my Nokia 6610. I have a DVD player. I use my Apple PowerBook to surf the Net and to chat using MSN Messenger.

Which are your favourite movies that use a lot of technology?

Finding Nemo and *Shrek* are the best animated movies that I have seen.

What do you surf the Net for?

I use the net for information on musicals, dance dramas, theatre, animals and even terminal diseases like AIDS and on street children.

How do you see technology affecting people?

Technology cannot work in isolation. When blended with art, technology will have a heart, and be of greater service to mankind than be used for destructive purposes.

Preethi Chamikuttu

IT WILL BE CHENNAI AND HYDERABAD

Mumbai, Bangalore No Longer IT Hotspots: Gartner

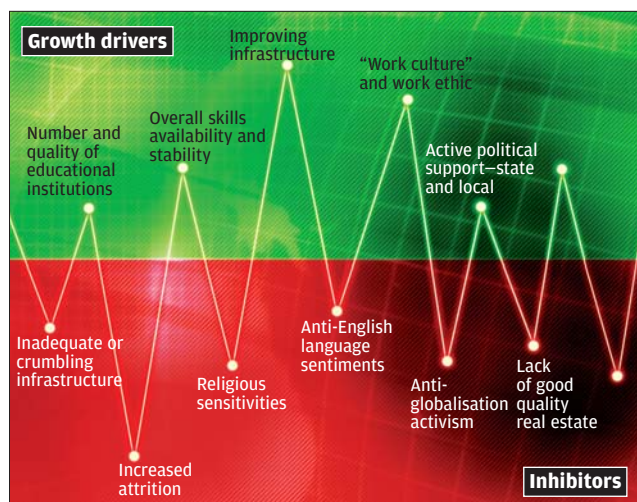
Although Google bosses Larry Page and Sergey Brin chose India's “Garden City” to set up their first offshore R&D unit outside the US, IT research firm Gartner says Chennai and Hyderabad will soon replace Bangalore and Mumbai as the most favoured destinations for offshore projects by 2010. In terms of innovation in the IT sector, Pune tops the list with the highest ratings in skills availability and retention.

The drivers studied include efforts to improve infrastructure, overall availability of skills, quality educational institutions and active political support. The main factors inhibiting growth were increased attrition rates, inadequate infrastructure, escalating costs and lack of quality real estate.

With significant investment, Gartner predicts that Pune, which ranked lowest in infrastructure support, will soon be on par with the other metros in the near future. Mumbai, surprisingly, received the lowest ratings on the “Cost of Life” and “Quality of Living” index.

Lower attrition rates and availability of skilled labour force are likely to be the main factors that will enable cities such as Chennai, Hyderabad and Pune steal a march over the current IT strongholds.

The poor infrastructure



Factors promoting and inhibiting growth of IT, in the top six metros (New Delhi, Mumbai, Bangalore, Pune, Chennai and Hyderabad), according to Gartner's 'IT Outsourcing to India—Analysis of Cities' (Dec 04)

gong was sounded in Bangalore recently when software companies including Infosys and Wipro threatened to migrate to other states. Infosys chief N R Narayanamurthy is believed to have written to Prime Minister Manmohan Singh complaining that poor infrastructure and pressure from the local “land mafia” was hampering business development in the city. Rumours that Wipro's Azim Premji may be considering shifting base to Delhi are also flying thick and fast.

Do the software-wallahs agree? Ajay Sharma, CEO of Bangalore-based Srishti Software, which develops Knowledge Management products, agrees that that development in Bangalore

has not kept pace with growth of the industry. “The Infy and Wipro threats only reflect a pressure point. Unless we have better roads, good power supply and infrastructure, it will be difficult for the industry to grow,” he laments.

India Inc needs to get its act together, at least to ensure that we don't lose considerable outsourcing business to our Asian counterparts. Paul Nixon, country manager, Oneyma Consulting, points out that in 10 years, “It may not be India at all which excites the west, but destinations like China and the Philippines. Already, some voice work is moving away from India to the Philippines and one BPO, which also has a presence in